

Introduction

This Fast Track to .NET will get you started with Microsoft's programming model, engine and tools for quickly building Windows applications targeted towards the .net framework. The release of .NET Framework 4 changes several development paradigms from previous versions: everything is now easier to create, execute, and maintain, and you can implement a host of new functionality.

In the first few chapters, you will get to know the basics of creating, hosting and running a .net application. The next few chapters on C# are intended to be an introduction to the programming language and its various constructs in the .NET Framework 4 and Visual Studio 2010, including the new GUI designer, expressions, variables and arguments. Additionally, you will explore the use of some basic built-in activities.

Next, you will be creating a GUI application that mimics a Calculator. The workflow of the application will be constructed both using the designer and XAML, and also using C# code. You will also get to learn event handling and adding conditional logic to the application by using various commands and functions. Finally, you will learn about thread handling and parallelism in .net applications.

Across this book, we will be using the "write the code first" approach, which primarily consists on first writing a code for the new feature being added and then understanding the necessary code to learn the finer nuances of .NET programming. 